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Operating a portable medical device

Abstract

Some embodiments of a portable medical device, such as an infusion pump, can receive an external reference signal (e.g., a radio, cellular and/or satellite signal) to provide an automatic time-setting and maintenance operation. In these circumstances, the medical device can maintain accurate time and date information even in the event of a power interruption, a time-zone change and/or an internal clock error, for example. In this manner, the portable medical device provides safe operation and added convenience to the user.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/256,055, filed Jan. 24, 2019, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/504,899, filed Oct. 2, 2014 by Estes et al. (now U.S. Pat. No. 10,226,572), which is a division of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 13/344,836 filed on Jan. 6, 2012 by Estes et al. (now U.S. Pat. No. 8,870,853), which is a continuation of U.S. patent

application Ser. No. 12/781,450 filed on May 17, 2010 by Estes et al. (now U.S. Pat. No. 8,109,921), which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 11/851,194 filed on Sep. 6, 2007 by Estes et al. (now U.S. Pat. No. 7,717,903), the contents of all of these previous applications being fully incorporated herein by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) This document relates to operating a medical device, such as an infusion pump to dispense a medicine.

BACKGROUND

(2) Medical devices are commonly implemented to provide medical treatment to a patient. Pump devices, for example, are commonly used to deliver one or more fluids to a targeted individual. As one specific example, a medical infusion pump device may be used to deliver a medicine to a patient as part of a medical treatment. The medicine that is delivered by the infusion pump device can depend on the condition of the patient and the desired treatment plan. For example, infusion pump devices have been used to deliver insulin to the vasculature of diabetes patients so as to regulate blood-glucose levels. Such treatment plans include scheduled dosages of a particular medicine. The dosage amounts can vary depending upon the time of day.

SUMMARY

(3) Some embodiments of a portable medical device for treatment of diabetes, such as an infusion pump or a glucose monitoring system, can receive an external reference signal (e.g., a radio, cellular and/or satellite signal) to provide an automatic time-setting and maintenance operation. In these circumstances, the medical device can maintain accurate time and date information even in the event of a power interruption, a time-zone change and/or an internal clock error, for example. In this manner, the portable medical device provides safe operation and added convenience to the user.

(4) Some embodiments of a method of operating a portable medical device include receiving an external reference signal from an external reference source, updating at least one of a time setting and date setting of the medical device based on the external reference signal to provide at least one of an updated time and updated date setting and operating the portable medical device based on the external reference signal.

(5) In particular embodiments, a portable medical device assembly include an external reference system that receives an external reference signal from an external reference source and a controller that updates at least one of a time setting and a date setting of the medical device based on the external reference signal to provide at least one of an updated time setting and an updated date setting. The controller operates the portable medical device based on at least one of the updated time setting and the updated date setting.

(6) Certain embodiments of a wearable infusion pump system include a disposable and non-reusable pump device including a drive system to dispense medicine from the pump device, the pump device having a first electrical connector that is externally accessible, a reusable controller device removably attachable to the disposable and non-reusable pump device. Some embodiments of the controller device include a second electrical connector that is engageable with the first connector to provide electrical communication between control circuitry of the controller device and the drive system of the pump device, an external reference system that receives an external reference signal from an external reference source, and a processor that updates at least one of a time setting and a date setting of the infusion pump system based on the external reference signal to provide at least one of an updated time setting and an updated date setting. The reusable controller operates the portable medical device based on at least one of the updated time setting and the updated date setting.

(7) Some or all of the embodiments described herein may provide one or more of the following advantages. First, an internal reference time set and/or updated by an external time signal to

maintain accurate time and date information even in the event of a power interruption. For example, power may be removed during a battery change and/or the battery may deplete over time. Upon re-powering, the external reference system automatically communicates with the remote time and date reference source and immediately and accurately updates the internal reference time and date. In this manner, the system can reduce the risk of the reference time either not being updated or not being accurately updated by the user. Furthermore, the accuracy of the internal reference time is maintained throughout the operation of the medical device.

(8) Secondly, the infusion pump system that incorporates the external reference system can be implemented to automatically adjust the dosing schedule in the case of a time change. More specifically, in the case of daylight savings time and/or travel between time zones, a time change may occur, which may be several hours or even an entire day. The patient may be alerted to such time changes and may be assisted in adapting the dosing schedule to the new time zone.

(9) Thirdly, the use of the medical device is simplified for the patient. More specifically, the patient is not required to manually set the date and time. As a result, any inaccuracies that may otherwise arise from manually setting the date and time are avoided. Furthermore, the user is not necessarily required to learn how to perform manual setting of the time and date.

(10) The details of one or more embodiments of the invention are set forth in the accompanying drawings and the description below. Other features, objects, and advantages of the invention will be apparent from the description and drawings, and from the claims.

Description

DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of an exemplary medical device in the form of an infusion pump system in accordance with some embodiments.

(2) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of the infusion pump system of FIG. 1 in an assembled state.

(3) FIG. 3 is another perspective view of the infusion pump system of FIG. 2.

(4) FIG. 4 is a perspective view of the infusion pump system of FIG. 1 in a detached state.

(5) FIG. 5 is another perspective view of the infusion pump system of FIG. 4.

(6) FIG. 6 is a perspective view of the infusion pump system, in accordance with some embodiments.

(7) FIG. 7 is a perspective view of the infusion pump system of FIG. 6 worn on clothing of a user.

(8) FIG. 8 is a perspective view of an infusion pump system worn on skin of a user, in accordance with particular embodiments.

(9) FIGS. 9 and 10 are perspective views of a pump device being detached from a controller device, in accordance with some embodiments.

(10) FIGS. 11 and 12 are perspective views of the pump device of FIGS. 9 and 10 being discarded and the controller device of FIGS. 9 and 10 being reused with a new pump device.

(11) FIGS. 13 and 14 are perspective views of the pump device of FIG. 11 being attached to the controller device of FIG. 11.

(12) FIG. 15 is an exploded perspective view of a controller device for an infusion pump system, in accordance with some embodiments.

(13) FIG. 16 is a flowchart illustrating automatic time and date setting and maintenance in accordance with an exemplary embodiment.

(14) FIG. 17 is an exploded perspective view of a pump device for an infusion pump system, in accordance with some embodiments.

(15) FIG. 18 is a perspective view of a continuous glucose monitoring system in accordance with some embodiments.

(16) Like reference symbols in the various drawings indicate like elements.

(17) Referring to FIGS. 1-3, an exemplary medical device is provided as a portable infusion pump system **10** that is configured to controllably dispense a medicine to a patient. Although the exemplary medical device is described as a medical infusion pump system **10**, it is appreciated that the automatic time and date setting and maintenance features described herein can be implemented in other medical devices, such as blood glucose meters and continuous blood glucose monitors (described in more detail below in connection with FIG. 18).

(18) The infusion pump system **10** can include a pump device **100** and a controller device **200** that communicates with the pump device **100**. The pump device **100** includes a housing structure **110** that defines a cavity **116** in which a fluid cartridge **120** can be received. The pump device **100** also includes a cap device **130** to retain the fluid cartridge **120** in the cavity **116** of the housing structure **110**. The pump device **100** includes a drive system (described in more detail below in connection with FIG. 17) that advances a plunger **125** in the fluid cartridge **120** so as to dispense fluid therefrom. The controller device **200** communicates with the pump device **100** to control the operation of the drive system. When the controller device **200**, the pump device **100** (including the cap device **130**), and the fluid cartridge **120** are assembled together, the user can (in some embodiments) conveniently wear the infusion pump system **10** on the user's skin under clothing or in the user's pocket while receiving the fluid dispensed from the pump device **100**.

(19) The controller device **200** may be configured as a reusable component that provides electronics and a user interface to control the operation of the pump device **100**. In such circumstances, the pump device **100** can be a disposable component that is disposed of after a single use. For example, the pump device **100** can be a “one time use” component that is thrown away after the fluid cartridge **120** therein is exhausted. Thereafter, the user can removably attach a new pump device **100** to the reusable controller device **200** for the dispensation of fluid from a new fluid cartridge **120**. Accordingly, the user is permitted to reuse the controller device **200** (which may include complex or valuable electronics) while disposing of the relatively low-cost pump device **100** after each use. Such a pump system **10** can provide enhanced user safety as a new pump device **100** (and drive system therein) is employed with each new fluid cartridge **120**.

(20) Briefly, in use, the infusion pump system **10** is configured to receive an external signal from a remote time and date reference source **235** (e.g., a radio transmitter, a satellite, another broadcast source or the like) to provide automatic time-setting capabilities and related maintenance features. For example, the controller device **200** may include a receiver **232** (FIG. 1) and external reference circuitry (FIG. 15) that can be used to receive the external reference signal, which provides time and/or date information. The controller device **200** can use this information to automatically update the time and date settings and thereafter provide accurately timed delivery of the infused medication, accurately time-stamped data storage, and other features convenient to the user. Such embodiments are described in more detail below in connection with FIGS. 15-16.

(21) In addition, the pump device **100** is configured to removably attach to the controller device **200** in a manner that provides a secure fitting, an overall compact size, and a reliable electrical connection that is resistant to water migration. For example, as described in more detail below in connection with FIGS. 1-5, the controller device **200** includes a housing **210** having a number of features that mate with complementary features of the pump housing **110**. In such circumstances, the controller device **200** can removably attach with the pump device **100** in a generally side-by-side configuration while not fully surrounding the pump housing **110**. Accordingly, the pump device **100** and the controller device **200** can be separate components that fit together, but the overall size of the combined assembly is reduced because there is no requirement for one component (e.g., the controller device) to completely surround or envelop the second component (e.g., the pump device). The compact size permits the infusion pump system **10** to be discrete and portable (as described below in connection with FIGS. 6-8). Moreover, at least one of the pump device **100** or the controller device **200** may include a release member that facilitates an easy-to-

use detachment and replacement process. For example, as described in more detail below in connection with FIGS. **11-16**, an exhausted pump device **100** may be a “one time use” component that is discarded after being used, and a new pump device **100'** (having a new medicine cartridge **120'**) can thereafter be attached to the controller device **200**.

(22) Moreover, the pump device **100** and the controller device **200** can be mounted to one another so that the assembled system **10** is resistant to migration of external contaminants (e.g., water from precipitation or splashing, sweat, and the like) both into the pump housing structure **110** and the controller housing structure **210**. In particular, the infusion pump system **10** may include one or more seals that are arranged to hinder migration of external contaminants into the cavity of the pump device **100** (e.g., to protect the insulin container **120** and the drive system during operation). Also, the infusion pump system may include one or more gaskets arranged proximate to the electrical connection location (between the pump device **100** and the controller device **200**) to protect the electrical connection from migration of external contaminants. Thus, in some embodiments, the infusion pump system **10** can be assembled into a water resistant configuration that protects sensitive components from water migration (e.g., if the user encounters water while wearing the pump system **10**).

(23) Still referring to FIGS. **1-3**, in this embodiment, the medical infusion pump system **10** is configured to controllably dispense a medicine from the cartridge **120**. As such, the fluid cartridge **120** may contain a medicine **126** (FIG. **1**) to be infused into the tissue or vasculature of a targeted individual, such as a human or animal patient. For example, the pump device **100** can be adapted to receive a medicine cartridge **120** in the form of a carpule that is preloaded with insulin or another medicine for use in the treatment of Diabetes (e.g., Byetta®, Symlin®, or others). Such a cartridge **120** may be supplied, for example, by Eli Lilly and Co. of Indianapolis, IN. Other examples of medicines contained in the fluid cartridge **120** include: pain relief drugs, hormone therapy, blood pressure treatments, anti-emetics, osteoporosis treatments, or other injectable medicines. The fluid cartridge **120** may have other configurations. For example, the fluid cartridge may comprise a reservoir that is integral with the pump housing structure **110** (e.g., the fluid cartridge can be defined by one or more walls of the pump housing structure **110** that surround a plunger to define a reservoir in which the medicine is injected or otherwise received).

(24) In some embodiments, the pump device **100** may include one or more structures that interfere with the removal of the medicine cartridge **120** after the medicine cartridge **120** is inserted into the cavity **116**. For example, as shown in FIG. **1**, the pump housing structure **110** may include one or more retainer wings **119** that at least partially extend into the cavity **116** to engage a portion of the medicine cartridge **120** when the medicine cartridge **120** is installed therein. In this embodiment, the pump housing structure **110** includes a pair of opposing retainer wings **119** (only one is shown in the view in FIG. **1**) that flex toward the inner surface of the cavity **116** during insertion of the medicine cartridge **120**. After the medicine cartridge is inserted to a particular depth, the retainer wings **119** are biased to flex outward (toward the center of the cavity **116**) so that the retainer wings **119** engage a neck portion **129** of the medicine cartridge **120**. This engagement with the retainer wings **119** and the neck portion **129** hinder any attempts to remove the medicine cartridge **120** away from the pump device **100**.

(25) Such a configuration may facilitate the “one-time-use” feature of the pump device **100**. Because the retainer wings **119** interfere with attempts to remove the medicine cartridge **120** from the pump device **100**, the pump device **100** will be discarded along with the medicine cartridge **120** after the medicine cartridge **120** is emptied, expired, or otherwise exhausted. The retainer wings **119** may serve to hinder attempts to remove the exhausted medicine cartridge **120** and to insert a new medicine cartridge **120** into the previously used pump device **100**. Accordingly, the pump device **100** may operate in a tamper-resistant and safe manner because the pump device **100** can be designed with predetermined life expectancy (e.g., the “one-time-use” feature in which the pump device is discarded after the medicine cartridge **120** is emptied, expired, or otherwise exhausted).

(26) Still referring to FIGS. 1-3, the cap device **130** can be joined with the pump device **100** after the medicine cartridge is inserted in the cavity **116**. In this embodiment, the cap device **130** is multifunctional in that it performs a number of functions for the pump device operation. For example, attachment of the cap device **130** may cause one or more of the following preparatory functions: forcing the plunger **125** (FIG. 1) of the fluid cartridge **120** to engage with the piston rod (not shown), piercing a septum **121** of the fluid cartridge **120** to provide a flow path for the fluid, and priming the fluid cartridge **120** with a “break away” force to initiate movement of the plunger **125** in the fluid cartridge **120**. In addition or in the alternative, attachment of the cap device **130** may also cause one or more of the following safety related functions: aligning an occlusion sensor with a portion of the fluid flow path, sealing the pump housing **110** (e.g., using a polymeric o-ring seal **131** or the like) to resist migration of external contaminants into the cavity **116**, and ceasing or preventing the dispensation of fluid if the cap device **130** is improperly engaged with the pump housing **110**. In other embodiments, the cap device **130** may supplement or replace the previously described retainer wings **119** by locking into position after joining with the pump housing **110**, thereby hindering removal of the fluid cartridge **120** in the pump housing **110**.

(27) The cap device **130** can include one or more alignment tabs **132** that operate to ensure that the cap device **130** is joined with the pump housing **110** in a selected orientation. For example, as shown in FIGS. 2-3, the cap device **130** may include an output port **139** that connects with tubing (e.g., FIG. 6) for dispensation of the medicine to the user. The output port **139** may have an angled orientation such that a portion of the tubing extends transversely to the central axis of the cartridge **120** and cap device **130**. The alignment tabs **132** arranged on the body of the cap device **130** can align with adjacent surfaces of the controller housing **210** to provide the selected orientation of the output port during operation. If, for example, the cap device **130** were joined with the pump housing **100** in an orientation that is 180-degrees off from the selected orientation, the alignment tabs **132** would receive interference from the barrel channel **211** of the controller housing **210**. As such, the user would be unable to attach the pump device **100** to the controller **200**, thereby indicating to the user that the cap device **130** must be reoriented to the selected position.

(28) Still referring to FIGS. 1-3, the controller device **200** may be removably attached to the pump device **100** so that the two components are mechanically mounted to one another in a fixed relationship. Such a mechanical mounting can form an electrical connection between the removable controller device **200** and the pump device **100**. For example, the controller device **200** may be in electrical communication with a portion of a drive system (not shown in FIGS. 1-3) of the pump device **100**. As described in more detail below, the pump device **100** includes a drive system that causes controlled dispensation of the medicine or other fluid from the cartridge **120**. In some embodiments, the drive system incrementally advances a piston rod (not shown in FIGS. 1-3) longitudinally into the cartridge **120** so that the fluid is forced out of an output end **122**. The septum **121** (FIG. 1) at the output end **122** of the fluid cartridge **120** can be pierced to permit fluid outflow when the cap device **130** is connected to the pump housing structure **110** (described in more detail below). Thus, when the pump device **100** and the controller device **200** are attached and thereby electrically connected, the controller device **200** communicates electronic control signals via a hardwire-connection (e.g., electrical contacts or the like) to the drive system or other components of the pump device **100**. In response to the electrical control signals from the controller device **200**, the drive system **300** (FIG. 17) of the pump device **100** causes medicine to incrementally dispense from the medicine cartridge **120**.

(29) In some embodiments, the controller device is configured to removably attach to the pump device **100** in a side-by-side arrangement. As such, the controller device **200** can be electrically connected with the pump device **100** while the controller device **200** remains outside of the pump housing **110** (and, likewise, the pump device **100** remains outside of the controller housing **210**). Accordingly, the pump device **100** and the controller device **200** can be separate components that fit together, but the overall size of the combined assembly is reduced because there is no

requirement for one component (e.g., the controller device) to completely surround or envelop the second component (e.g., the pump device). The compact size permits the infusion pump system **10** to be discrete and portable when the pump device **100** is attached with the controller device **200** (as shown in FIGS. 2-3). In this embodiment, the controller device **200** includes a controller housing structure **210** having a number of features (e.g., a barrel channel **211**, a rail **212**, a depression **213**, and a guide channel **214a-b** that is segmented by a release latch **215**) that are configured to mate with complementary features (e.g., a barrel **111**, a slider channel **112**, an mating extension **113**, and a segmented guide rail **114a-b**) of the pump housing structure **110** so as to form a releasable mechanical connection (as shown, for example, in FIGS. 1 and 4-5). Such mating features of the pump housing structure **110** and the controller housing structure **210** can provide a secure connection in the previously described side-by-side arrangement. It should be understood that, in other embodiments, other features or connector devices can be used to facilitate the side-by-side mounting arrangement. These other features or connector devices may include, for example, magnetic attachment devices, mating tongues and grooves, or the like.

(30) As shown in FIG. 1, the pump device **100** may include an electrical connector **118** (e.g., having conductive pads, pins, and the like) that are exposed to the controller device **200** and that mate with a complementary electrical connector (refer to connector **218** in FIG. 4) on the adjacent face of the controller device **200**. The electrical connectors **118** and **218** provide the electrical communication between the control circuitry (refer, for example, to FIG. 15) housed in the controller device **200** and at least a portion of the drive system or other components of the pump device **100**. For example, in some embodiments, the electrical connectors **118** and **218** permit the transmission of electrical control signals to the pump device **100** and the reception of feedback signals (e.g., sensor signals) from particular components within the pump device **100**. Furthermore, as described in more detail below, the infusion pump system **10** may include a gasket **140** that provides a seal that is resistant to migration of external contaminants when the pump device **100** is attached to the controller device **200**. Thus, in some embodiments, the infusion pump system **10** can be assembled into a water resistant configuration that protects the electrical interconnection from water migration (e.g., if the user encounters water while carrying the pump system **10**).

(31) Still referring to FIGS. 1-3, the controller device **200** includes a user interface **220** that permits a user to monitor the operation of the pump device **100**. In some embodiments, the user interface **220** includes a display **222** and one or more user-selectable buttons (e.g., four buttons **224a**, **224b**, **224c**, and **224d** in this embodiment). The display **222** may include an active area in which numerals, text, symbols, images, or a combination thereof can be displayed (refer, for example, to FIG. 2). For example, the display **222** may be used to communicate a number of settings or menu options for the infusion pump system **10**. In this embodiment, the user may press one or more of the buttons **224a**, **224b**, **224c**, and **224d** to shuffle through a number of menus or program screens that show particular settings and data (e.g., review data that shows the medicine dispensing rate, the total amount of medicine dispensed in a given time period, the amount of medicine scheduled to be dispensed at a particular time or date, the approximate amount of medicine remaining in the cartridge **120**, or the like). In some embodiments, the user can adjust the settings or otherwise program the controller device **200** by pressing one or more buttons **224a**, **224b**, **224c**, and **224d** of the user interface **220**. For example, the user may press one or more of the buttons **224a**, **224b**, **224c**, and **224d** to change the dispensation rate of insulin or to request that a bolus of insulin be dispensed immediately or at a scheduled, later time. Also, the user can activate the illumination instrument **230** on the controller device **200** by pressing one or more buttons **224a**, **224b**, **224c**, and **224d** of the user interface **220**.

(32) The display **222** of the user interface **220** may be configured to display quick reference information when no buttons **224a**, **224b**, **224c**, and **224d** have been pressed. For example, as shown in FIG. 2, the active area of the display **222** can display the time and the date for a period of time after no button **224a**, **224b**, **224c**, and **224d** has been actuated (e.g., five seconds, 10 seconds,

30 seconds, 1 minute, 5 minutes, or the like). Thereafter, the display **222** may enter sleep mode in which the active area is blank, thereby conserving battery power. In addition or in the alternative, the active area can display particular device settings, such as the current dispensation rate or the total medicine dispensed, for a period of time after no button **224a**, **224b**, **224c**, or **224d** has been actuated (e.g., five seconds, 10 seconds, 30 seconds, 1 minute, 5 minutes, or the like). Again, thereafter the display **222** may enter sleep mode to conserve battery power. In certain embodiments, the display **222** can dim after a first period of time in which no button **224a**, **224b**, **224c**, or **224d** has been actuated (e.g., after 15 seconds or the like), and then the display **22** can enter sleep mode and become blank after a second period of time in which no button **224a**, **224b**, **224c**, or **224d** has been actuated (e.g., after 30 seconds or the like). Thus, the dimming of the display device **222** can alert a user viewing the display device **222** when the active area **223** of the display device will soon become blank.

(33) Accordingly, when the controller device **200** is connected to the pump device **100**, the user is provided with the opportunity to readily monitor infusion pump operation by simply viewing the user interface **220** of the controller device **200** connected to the pump device **100**. Such monitoring capabilities may provide comfort to a user who may have urgent questions about the current operation of the pump device **100** (e.g., the user may be unable to receive immediate answers if wearing an infusion pump device having no user interface attached thereto).

(34) Also, in these embodiments, there may be no need for the user to carry and operate a separate module to monitor the operation of the infusion pump device **100**, thereby simplifying the monitoring process and reducing the number of devices that must be carried by the user. If a need arises in which the user desires to monitor the operation of the pump device **100** or to adjust settings of the pump system **10** (e.g., to request a bolus amount of medicine), the user can readily operate the user interface **220** of the controller device **200**, which is removably attached to the pump device **100**, without the requirement of locating and operating a separate monitoring module.

(35) In other embodiments, the user interface **200** is not limited to the display and buttons depicted in FIGS. 1-3. For example, in some embodiments, the user interface **220** may include only one button or may include a greater numbers of buttons, such as two buttons three buttons, four buttons, five buttons, or more. In another example, the user interface **220** of the controller device **200** may include a touch screen so that a user may select buttons defined by the active area of the touch screen display. Alternatively, the user interface **220** may comprise audio inputs or outputs so that a user can monitor the operation of the pump device **100**.

(36) Referring now to FIGS. 4-5, when the infusion pump system **10** operates, the controller device **200** is removably attached to the pump device **100** in a side-by-side arrangement. For example, the pump device **100** may be moved in a longitudinal direction (e.g., refer to direction **219** in FIG. 13) toward the controller device **200** until the complementary features connect and secure the separate components in the side-by-side arrangement. In these circumstances, the pump device **100** and the controller device **200** can be separate components that fit together, but the overall size of the combined assembly is reduced because there is no requirement for one component (e.g., the controller device or pump device) to surround or envelop the second component (e.g., the pump device or controller device). Moreover, in some embodiments, the pump device **100** and controller device **200** can be readily attached together with a “one-movement” process that is convenient to the user (described in more detail below).

(37) In this embodiment, the controller device **200** includes a controller housing structure **210** having a number of features that are configured to mate with complementary features of the pump housing structure **110** so as to form a releasable mechanical connection. For example, the pump housing structure **110** may include a barrel **111** that mates with a complementary barrel channel **211** of the controller housing **210**. Also, the pump housing **110** includes slider channel **112** that slidably engages a complementary rail **212** defined by the controller housing **210**. The slider channel **112** can guide the relative motion between the pump device **100** and the controller device **200** in the

longitudinal direction during the attachment process. Similarly, the pump housing **110** may include a segmented rail **114a-b** (FIG. 1) that mates with a guide channel **214a-b** to direct the relative longitudinal motion between the pump device **100** and the controller device **200**. As described in more detail below, the segmented rails **114a-b** may interact with the release member **215** so as to releasably secure the pump device **100** into assembly with the controller device **200**. In addition, the pump housing **110** may include an extension **113** (FIG. 1) that mates with a depression **213** (FIG. 4) in the controller housing **210** when the pump device **100** is fully attached to the controller device **200**.

(38) Still referring to FIGS. 4-5, when the pump device **100** is advanced in the longitudinal direction toward the controller device **200** as guided by the slider channel **112** and the segmented rails **114a-b**, the electrical connector **118** (FIG. 5) of the pump device **100** is directed toward engagement with the mating connector **218** (FIG. 4) of the controller device **200**. As the connectors **118** and **218** join together to form the electrical connection, the release member **215** is shifted to a position between the segmented rails **114a-b** so as to prevent withdrawal of the connection. Also, when the connectors **118** and **218** are mated, the extension **113** and barrel **111** are mated with the corresponding depression **213** and barrel channel **211** so as to resist relative rotational movement between the pump device **100** and the controller device **200**. In this embodiment, the physical attachment of the electrical connectors **118** and **218** may also serve to resist relative rotational movement between the pump device **100** and the controller device **200**. Furthermore, when the connectors **118** and **218** are mated, the slide channel **112** is mated with the corresponding rail **112** and barrel channel **211** so as to resist relative side-to-side movement between the pump device **100** and the controller device **200**.

(39) Accordingly, the pump device **100** is configured to removably attach to the controller device **200** in a manner that provides a secure fitting, an overall compact size, and a reliable electrical connection. When the pump device **100** and the controller device **200** are arranged in this side-by-side configuration, the controller device **200** can be electrically connected with the pump device **100** while the controller device **200** remains outside of the pump housing **110** (and, likewise, the pump device **100** remains outside of the controller housing **210**). As such, the overall size of the assembled system **10** can be minimized, thereby providing an infusion pump system **10** having a discrete size and enhanced portability.

(40) Additionally, in some embodiments, the attachment of the pump device **100** to the controller device **200** can be accomplished by a user with a convenient “one-movement” process. For example, as previously described, the user can readily slide the pump device **100** and the controller device **200** toward one another in a single movement (e.g., in the longitudinal direction) that causes both a physical connection and an electrical connection. As described in more detail below in connection with FIGS. 9-14, the release member **215** may be arranged so as to automatically adjust to a locked position when the pump device **100** is advanced into engagement with the controller device **200**. Thus, the infusion pump system **10** permits users to readily join the pump device **100** and the controller device **200** without compound or otherwise difficult hand movements—a feature that can be beneficial to child users or to elderly users.

(41) It should be understood that, in other embodiments, other features or connector devices can be used to facilitate the side-by-side mounting arrangement. These other features or connector devices may include, for example, magnetic attachment device, mating tongues and grooves, mounting protrusions that friction fit into mating cavities, or the like.

(42) Still referring to FIGS. 4-5, the pump device **100** and the controller device **200** can be attached in a manner that is resistant to migration of external contaminants (e.g., water, dirt, and the like) both into the pump housing structure **110** and the controller housing structure **210**. For example, when the pump device **100** is advanced in the longitudinal direction toward the controller device **200** (as guided by the slider channel **112** and the segmented rails **114a-b**), the electrical connector **118** (FIG. 5) of the pump device **100** is directed toward engagement with the mating connector **218**

(FIG. 4) of the controller device **200**. When the connectors **118** and **218** join together to form the electrical connection, the gasket **140** is compressed between the adjacent surfaces of the pump housing **110** and the controller housing **210**. The gasket **140** thereby forms a water-resistant seal between the ambient environment and the mated connectors **118** and **218**.

(43) The gasket **140** may comprise a polymer foam material that is adhered to a surface of either the pump housing **110** or the controller housing **210** (e.g., adhered to the pump housing **110** in this embodiment). The gasket **140** may be die cut to a selected shape so as to include an aperture for the electrical connection. Thus, in this embodiment, the gasket **140** surrounds the electrical connection when the pump device **100** is secured to the controller device **200**. The configuration provides protection from water migration to one or both of the electrical connectors **118** and **218**.

Accordingly, in particular circumstances, the infusion pump system **10** can be assembled into a “water tight” configuration that protects sensitive internal components from water migration in the event that the user encounters water while wearing the pump system **10**. In one example, the gasket **140** may resist migration of water to the electrical connectors **118** and **218** even when the system **10** is submerged underwater (e.g., in a pool, in a bath, or the like) for an extended period of time, such as at least 10 minutes, at least 30 minutes, at least one hour, at least two hours, and preferably at least four hours.

(44) As shown in FIG. 5, the gasket **140** is arranged to extend generally perpendicular to the assembly motion when the pump device **100** is being attached to the controller device. For example, the pump device **100** can be attached to the controller device **200** by moving the pump device **100** in the longitudinal direction (e.g., refer to direction **219** in FIG. 13). The gasket **140** includes a major interface surface extends in a generally lateral direction that is perpendicular to the longitudinal assembly motion. Because the gasket **140** extends in a direction (e.g., the lateral direction in this embodiments) that is generally perpendicular to the attachment direction (the longitudinal direction in this embodiment), the gasket **140** can be sufficiently compressed to form a seal when the user performs the “one-movement” process to attach the pump device **100** and the controller device **200**.

(45) In addition, other paths for migration of external contaminants into the assembled pump system **10** may be sealed. For example, the pump system **10** may include one or more seals that are arranged to hinder migration of external contaminants between the cap device **130** and the pump housing **110** into the cavity **116** of the pump device **100**. In this embodiment, the seal **131** arranged between the cap device **130** and the barrel **111** can provide an effective water-resistant seal against water migration into the cavity. As such, the medicine cartridge **120** and pump drive system (not shown in FIGS. 4-5) can be protected during operation.

(46) Still referring to FIGS. 4-5, some embodiments of the infusion pump system **10** may employ a power source arranged in pump device **100** or the controller device **200** that draws upon surrounding air for optimum operation. Because the controller device **200** and the pump device **100** may be sealed to resist water migration during normal usage, a water-resistant vent instrument **145** may be used to provide the air to the power source without permitting migration of water therethrough. For example, in this embodiment, the pump device **100** may house a power source in the form of a zinc-air cell battery **345** (FIG. 17), which draws upon the surrounding air during operation. When the pump device **100** is in use, the pump housing **110** is preferably sealed to protect the internal drive system **300** (FIG. 17) and medicine cartridge from water migration. As such, the pump housing **110** may include a water-resistant vent instrument disposed proximate to the zinc-air cell battery **345** so that some air may pass through the vent and toward the battery. The water-resistant vent instrument may include one or more layers of a material that is permeable to air and resistant to passage of liquids such as water. For example, the water-resistant vent instrument may include one or more layers of a GORE-TEX material to resist the migration of water into the pump device while permitting the passage of air toward the battery.

(47) Accordingly, the pump device **100** and the controller device **200** can be mounted to one

another so that the assembled system **10** is resistant to water migration both into the pump housing structure **110** and the controller housing structure **210**. Such a configuration may also provide water-resistant protection for the electrical connection between the pump device **100** and the controller **200**. Thus, the sensitive internal components in the controller device **200** and the pump device **100** can be reliably protected from water migration if the user encounters water (e.g., rain, incidental splashing, and the like) while using the pump system **10**.

(48) Referring to FIGS. **6-8**, the infusion pump system **10** may be configured to be portable and can be wearable and concealable. For example, a user can conveniently wear the infusion pump system **10** on the user's skin (e.g., skin adhesive) underneath the user's clothing or carry the pump device **100** in the user's pocket (or other portable location) while receiving the medicine dispensed from the pump device **100**. The drive system of the pump device **100** may be arranged in a compact manner so that the pump device **100** has a reduced length. For example, in the circumstances in which the medicine cartridge **120** has a length of about 6 cm to about 7 cm (about 6.4 cm in one embodiment), the overall length of the pump housing structure **110** (which contains medicine cartridge and the drive system) can be about 7 cm to about 10 cm and about 7 cm to about 9 cm (about 8.3 cm or less in one embodiment). In addition, the pump housing structure **110** may have an overall height of about 2 cm to about 4 cm (about 3.1 cm or less in one embodiment) and an overall thickness of about 8 mm to about 20 mm (about 17.5 mm or less in one embodiment). In such circumstances, the controller device **200** can be figured to mate with the pump housing **110** so that, when removably attached to one another, the components define a portable infusion pump system that stores a relatively large quantity of medicine compared to the overall size of the unit. For example, in this embodiment, the infusion pump system **10** (including the removable controller device **200** attached to the pump device **100** having the cap **130**) may have an overall length of about 7 cm to about 10 cm (about 9.3 cm or less in one embodiment), an overall height of about 2 cm to about 5 cm (about 4.2 cm or less in one embodiment), and an overall thickness of about 8 mm to about 20 mm (about 17.5 mm or less in one embodiment).

(49) The infusion pump system **10** is shown in FIG. **6** as being held in a user's hand **5** so as to illustrate an exemplary size of the system **10** in accordance with some embodiments. This embodiment of the infusion pump system **10** is compact so that the user can wear the system **10** (e.g., in the user's pocket, connected to a belt clip, adhered to the user's skin, or the like) without the need for carrying and operating a separate module. In such embodiments, the cap device **130** of the pump device **100** may be configured to mate with an infusion set **146**. In general, the infusion set **146** is tubing system that connects the infusion pump system **10** to the tissue or vasculature of the user (e.g., to deliver medicine into the tissue or vasculature under the user's skin).

(50) The infusion set **146** may include a flexible tube **147** that extends from the pump device **100** to a subcutaneous cannula **149** retained by a skin adhesive patch **148** that secures the subcutaneous cannula **149** to the infusion site. The skin adhesive patch **148** can retain the infusion cannula **149** in fluid communication with the tissue or vasculature of the patient so that the medicine dispensed through the tube **147** passes through the cannula **149** and into the user's body. The cap device **130** may provide fluid communication between the output end **122** (FIG. **1**) of the medicine cartridge **120** and the tube **147** of the infusion set **146**. For example, the tube **147** may be directly connected to the output port **139** (FIG. **1**) of the cap device **130**. In another example, the infusion set **146** may include a connector (e.g., a Leur connector or the like) attached to the tube **147**, and the connector can then mate with the cap device **130** to provide the fluid communication to the tube **147**. In these examples, the user can carry the portable infusion pump system **10** (e.g., in the user's pocket, connected to a belt clip, adhered to the user's skin, or the like) while the tube **147** extends to the location in which the skin is penetrated for infusion. If the user desires to monitor the operation of the pump device **100** or to adjust the settings of the infusion pump system **10**, the user can readily access the user interface **220** of the controller device **200** without the need for carrying and operating a separate module (refer for example to FIG. **6**).

(51) Referring to FIG. 7, in some embodiments, the infusion pump system **10** is pocket-sized so that the pump device **100** and controller device **200** can be worn in the user's pocket **6** or in another portion of the user's clothing. For example, the pump device **100** and the controller device **200** can be attached together and form the system that comfortably fits into a user's pocket **6**. The user can carry the portable infusion pump system **10** and use the tube **147** of the infusion set **146** extends to direct the dispensed medicine to the desired infusion site. In some circumstances, the user may desire to wear the infusion pump system **10** in a more discrete manner. Accordingly, the user may pass the tube **147** from the pocket **6**, under the user's clothing, and to the infusion site where the adhesive patch **148** is positioned. As such, the pump system **10** can be used to delivery medicine to the tissues or vasculature of the user in a portable, concealable, and discrete manner.

(52) Referring to FIG. 8, in other embodiments, the infusion pump system **10** may be configured to adhere to the user's skin **7** directly at the location in which the skin is penetrated for medicine infusion. For example, a rear surface **102** (FIG. 3) of the pump device **100** may include a skin adhesive patch so that the pump device **100** is physically adhered to the skin of the user at a particular location. In these embodiments, the cap device **130** may have a configuration in which medicine passes directly from the cap device **130** into an infusion cannula **149** that is penetrated into the user's skin. In one example, the fluid output port **139** through the cap device **130** can include a curve or a 90° corner so that the medicine flow path extends longitudinally out of the medicine cartridge and thereafter laterally toward the patient's skin **7**. Again, if the user desires to monitor the operation of the pump device **100** or to adjust the settings of the infusion pump system **10**, the user can readily access the user interface **220** of the controller device **200** without the need for carrying and operating a second, separate device. For example, the user may look toward the pump device **100** to view the user interface **220** of the controller device **200** that is removably attached thereto. In another example, the user can temporarily detach the controller device **200** (while the pump device **100** remains adhered to the skin **7**) so as to view and interact with the user interface **220**.

(53) Referring now to FIGS. 9-14, the infusion pump system **10** can be operated such that the pump device **100** is a disposable, non-reusable component while the controller device **200** is a reusable component. In these circumstances, the pump device **100** may be configured as a “one-time-use” device that is discarded after the medicine cartridge is emptied, expired, or otherwise exhausted. Thus, in some embodiments, the pump device **100** may be designed to have an expected operational life of about 1 day to about 30 days, about 1 day to about 20 days, about 1 to about 14 days, or about 1 day to about 7 days—depending on the volume of medicine in the cartridge **120**, the dispensation patterns that are selected for the individual user, and other factors. For example, in some embodiments, the medicine cartridge **120** containing insulin may have an expected usage life about 7 days after the cartridge is removed from a refrigerated state and the septum **121** is punctured. In some circumstances, the dispensation pattern selected by the user can cause the insulin to be emptied from the medicine cartridge **120** before the 7-day period. If the insulin is not emptied from the medicine cartridge **120** after the 7-day period, the remaining insulin may become expired sometime thereafter. In either case, the pump device **100** and the medicine cartridge **120** therein can be discarded after exhaustion of the medicine cartridge **120** (e.g., after being emptied, expired, or otherwise not available for use).

(54) The controller device **200**, however, may be reused with subsequent new pump devices **100'** and new medicine cartridges **120'**. As such, the control circuitry, the user interface components, and other components that may have relatively higher manufacturing costs can be reused over a longer period of time. For example, in some embodiments, the controller device **200** may be designed to have an expected operational life of about 1 year to about 7 years, about 2 years to about 6 years, or about 3 years to about 5 years—depending on a number of factors including the usage conditions for the individual user. Accordingly, the user is permitted to reuse the controller device **200** (which may include complex or valuable electronics) while disposing of the relatively low-cost pump

device **100** after each use. Such a pump system **10** can provide enhanced user safety as a new pump device **100'** (and drive system therein) is employed with each new fluid cartridge **120**.

(55) Referring to FIGS. **9-10**, the pump device **100** can be readily removed from the controller device **200** when the medicine cartridge **120** is exhausted. As previously described, the medicine cartridge **120** is inserted into the cavity **116** (FIG. **1**) of the pump housing **110** where it is retained by the cap device **130**. In some embodiments, a portion of the pump housing **110** can comprise a transparent or translucent material so that at least a portion of the medicine cartridge **120** is viewable therethrough. For example, the user may want to visually inspect the medicine cartridge when the plunger **125** is approaching the output end **122** of the medicine cartridge, thereby providing a visual indication that the medicine cartridge may be emptied in the near future. In this embodiment, the barrel **111** of the pump housing **110** comprises a generally transparent polymer material so that the user can view the medicine cartridge **120** to determine if the plunger **125** is nearing the end of its travel length. Optionally, some embodiments of the pump device **100** may include a label **117a** that is adhered around the barrel **111**. The label **117a** may provide a convenient location for basic user instructions, product identification information, and other information related to the infusion pump system **10**. To provide enhanced viewability of the medicine cartridge **120** through the label **117a**, the label **117a** may include a window **117b** through which the user may visually inspect if the plunger **125** is nearing the end of its travel length.

(56) As shown in FIG. **9**, the pump device **100** has been used to a point at which the medicine cartridge **120** is exhausted. The plunger **125** has been advanced, toward the left in FIG. **9**, over a period of time so that all or most of the medicine has been dispensed from the cartridge **120**. In some embodiments, the controller device **200** may provide a visual or audible alert when this occurs so as to remind the user that a new medicine cartridge is needed. In addition or in the alternative, the user may visually inspect the medicine cartridge **120** through the barrel **111** of the pump housing **110** (and through the window **117b** of the label **117a** in this embodiment) to determine if the medicine cartridge **120** is almost empty. When the user determines that a new medicine cartridge **120** should be employed, the pump device **100** can be readily separated from the controller device **200** by actuating the release member **215**. In this embodiment, the release member **215** is a latch on the controller device **200** that is biased toward a locking position to engage the pump device **100**. The latch may be arranged to engage one or more features on a lateral side of the pump housing **110**. As such, the user may actuate the release member **215** by moving the release member **215** in a lateral direction **216** (FIG. **9**) away from the pump device **100** (e.g., by applying a force with the user's finger).

(57) As shown in FIG. **10**, when the release member **215** is actuated and moved to a position away from the pump device **100**, the segmented guide rail **114a-b** is free to slide longitudinally in the guide channel **214a-b** without interference from the release member **215**. Accordingly, the user can move the pump device **100** in a longitudinal direction **217** away from the controller device **200**. For example, the segmented guide rail **114a-b** may slide along the guide channel **214a-b**, the extension **113** (FIG. **1**) may be withdrawn from the mating depression **213** (FIG. **10**), and the electrical connector **118** can be separated from the mating connector **218**. In these circumstances, the pump device **100** is physically and electrically disconnected from the controller device **200** while the pump device retains the exhausted medicine cartridge **120**.

(58) In some embodiments, the gasket **140** compressed between the pump device **100** and the controller device **200** may comprise a resilient material. In such circumstances, the gasket **140** can provide a spring-action that urges the pump device **100** to shift a small amount away from the controller device **200** when the release member **215** is moved to the unlocked position (e.g., move in the lateral direction **216** in the embodiment shown in FIG. **9**). Accordingly, in some embodiments, the pump device **100** can automatically and sharply move a small distance (e.g., about 0.5 mm to about 5 mm) away from the controller **200** when the release member **215** is moved to the unlocked position. Such an automatic separation provides a convenient start for the user to

detach the pump device **100** away from the controller device **200**. Furthermore, this automatic separation caused by the spring-action of the gasket **140** can provide a swift disconnect between the electrical connectors **118** and **218** when the pump device **100** is being replaced.

(59) Referring to FIGS. **11-12**, the same controller device **200** can be reused with a new pump device **100'** having a new medicine cartridge **120'** retained therein, and the previously used pump device **100** can be discarded with the exhausted medicine cartridge **120**. The new pump device **100'** (FIG. **11**) can have a similar appearance, form factor, and operation as the previously used pump device **100** (FIGS. **9,10** and **12**), and thus the new pump device **100'** can be readily attached to the controller device **200** for controlled dispensation of medicine from the new medicine cartridge **120'**. In some embodiments, the user may prepare the new pump device **100** for use with the controller device **200**. For example, the user may insert the new medicine cartridge **120'** in the cavity **116** of the new pump device **100'** and then join the cap device **130** to the pump housing to retain the new medicine cartridge **120'** therein (refer, for example, to FIG. **1**). Although the tubing **147** of the infusion set **146** is not shown in FIG. **11**, it should be understood that the tubing **147** may be attached to the cap device **130** prior to the cap device **130** being joined with the housing **110**. For example, a new infusion set **146** can be connected to the cap device **130** so that the tubing **147** can be primed (e.g., a selected function of the pump device **100** controlled by the controller **200**) before attaching the infusion set patch to the user's skin. As shown in FIG. **11**, the new medicine cartridge **120'** may be filled with medicine such that the plunger **125** is not viewable through the barrel **111**.

(60) As shown in FIG. **12**, the previously used pump device **100** that was separated from the controller device **200** (as described in connection with FIGS. **9-10**) may be discarded after a single use. In these circumstances, the pump device **100** may be configured as a disposable "one-time-use" device that is discarded by the user after the medicine cartridge **120** is emptied, is expired, has ended its useful life, or is otherwise exhausted. For example, the pump device **100** may be discarded into a bin **20**, which may include a trash bin or a bin specifically designated for discarded medical products. Thus, the user is permitted to dispose of the relatively low-cost pump device **100** after each use while reusing the controller device **200** (which may include complex or valuable electronics) with subsequent new pumps **100'**. Also, in some circumstances, the infusion set **146** (not shown in FIG. **12**, refer to FIG. **6**) that was used with the pump device **100** may be removed from the user and discarded into the bin **20** along with the pump device **100**. Alternatively, the infusion set **146** can be disconnected from the previous pump device **100** and attached to the new pump device **100'**. In these circumstances, the user may detach the infusion set cannula and patch from the skin so as to "re-prime" the tubing with medicine from the new pump device **100'** to remove air pockets from the tubing. Thereafter, the infusion set cannula and patch can be again secured to the user's skin.

(61) Referring to FIGS. **13-14**, the new pump device **100'** can be removably attached to the controller device **200** to assemble into the infusion pump system **10** for delivery of medicine to the user. Before the pump device **100** is electrically connected with the controller device **200**, the user may prepare the new pump device **100'** for use by pulling the removable tab **141** away from the pump housing **110**. In this embodiment, the new pump device **100'** includes the removable tab **141** to seal the battery in the unused pump device **100'** and thereby maintain the battery in a storage mode (refer, for example, to FIG. **12** in which the removable tab **141** is arranged to cover an internal face of the vent **145**). As described in more detail below, when the new pump device **100'** is prepared for usage, the removable tab **141** can be pulled away from the pump housing **110** (and away from the battery therein), which switches the battery into an activation mode. Thus, the shelf-life of the pump device **100'** (prior to usage with the controller device **200**) may be extended by sealing the battery in a storage mode because little, if any, energy is dissipated from the battery when in the storage mode.

(62) The pump device **100'** can be connected to the controller device **200** by advancing the pump

device **100'** in a longitudinal direction **219** (FIG. 13) toward the controller device **200**. When the pump device **100'** is advanced in the longitudinal direction **219** toward the controller device **200**, the movement is guided by the slider channel **112** (FIGS. 4-5) and the segmented rails **114a-b**. In particular, the slider channel **112** of the pump housing engages the rail **212** of the controller housing **210**. Also, the front portion of the segmented rail **114a** slides into the rear portion of the guide channel **214b**. In this embodiment, the front portion of the segmented rail **114a** includes a ramp surface **114c** (refer also to FIG. 1) that engages a complementary ramp surface **215c** (FIG. 4) of the release member **215** to thereby force the release member **215** away from the guide channel **214a-b** during advancement of the pump device **100'**. The release member **215** is temporarily forced away from the guide channel **214a-b** so that the front portion of the segmented rail **114a** passes over the release member **215**, which enables the electrical connector **118** of the pump device **100'** to engage with the mating connector **218** of the controller device **200**. As the connectors **118** and **218** join together to form the electrical connection, the release member **215** biased to return to its latched position and is shifted to a position in the guide channel **214a-b** between the segmented rails **114a-b** so as to prevent withdrawal of the pump device **100'**.

(63) Also, when the connectors **118** and **218** are mated, the extension **113** (FIG. 1) and barrel **111** are mated with the corresponding depression **213** and barrel channel **211** so as to resist relative rotational movement between the pump device **100** and the controller device **200**. In this embodiment, the physical attachment of electrical connectors **118** and **218** may also serve to resist relative rotational movement between the pump device **100** and the controller device **200**.

Furthermore, when the connectors **118** and **218** are mated, the slide channel **112** is mated with the corresponding rail **112** (FIG. 1) and barrel channel **211** so as to resist relative side-to-side movement between the pump device **100** and the controller device **200**.

(64) As previously described, the guided motion in the longitudinal direction **219** provides the user with a convenient “one-movement” process to attach the pump device **100'** and the controller device **200**. For example, the user can readily slide the pump device **100'** and the controller device **200** toward one another in a single movement (e.g., in the longitudinal direction) that causes both a physical connection and an electrical connection. Thus, the infusion pump system **10** permits users to readily join the pump device **100'** and the controller device **200** without compound or otherwise difficult hand movements—a feature that can be beneficial to child users or to elderly users.

(65) As shown in FIG. 14, when the pump device **100'** is fully advanced and attached to the controller device **200**, the gasket **140** is compressed between the opposing surfaces of the pump housing **110** and the controller housing **210**. Such a configuration provides a water-resistance seal around the electrical connection that protects the sensitive internal components of the pump device **100'** and the controller device **200** from damage or malfunction. Although the tubing **147** of the infusion set **146** is not shown in FIGS. 13-14, it should be understood that the tubing **147** may be attached to the cap device **130** to provide a fluid path from the new pump device **100'** to the user.

(66) Accordingly, the pump device **100'** can removably attach to the controller device **200** in a manner that provides a secure fitting, an overall compact size, and a reliable electrical connection. When the pump device **100'** and the controller device **200** are arranged in this side-by-side configuration, the controller device **200** can be electrically connected with the pump device **100'** while the controller device **200** remains outside of the pump housing **110** (and, likewise, the pump device **100** remains outside of the controller housing **210**). As such, the overall size of the system **10** can be minimized, thereby providing an infusion pump system having a discrete size and enhanced portability.

(67) Referring now to FIG. 15, the controller device **200** (shown in an exploded view) houses a number of components that can be reused with a series of successive pump devices **100**. In particular, the controller device **200** includes control circuitry **240** arranged in the controller housing **210** that is configured to communicate control signals to the drive system of the pump device **100**. In this embodiment, the control circuitry **240** includes a main processor board **242** that

is in communication with a power supply board **244**. The control circuitry **240** includes at least one processor **243** that coordinates the electrical communication to and from the controller device **200** (e.g., communication between the controller device **200** and the pump device **100**). The processor **243** can be arranged on the main processor board **242** along with a number of other electrical components such as memory devices. It should be understood that, although the main processor board **242** is depicted as a printed circuit board, the main processor board can have other forms, including multiple boards, a flexible circuit substrate, and other configurations that permit the processor **243** to operate. The control circuitry **240** can be programmable in that the user may provide one or more instructions to adjust a number of settings for the operation of the system **10**. Such settings may be stored in the memory devices arranged in the control circuitry **240**. Furthermore, the control circuitry **240** may include one or more dedicated memory devices that store executable software instructions for the processor **243**. The control circuitry **240** may include other components, such as sensors, that are electrically connected to the main processor board **242**. For example, at least a portion of the occlusion sensor **250** (not shown in FIG. **15**) can be electrically connected to the main processor board **242** via a flexible circuit substrate or one or more wires.

(68) Still referring to FIG. **15**, the user interface **220** of the controller device **200** can include input components, output components, or both that are electrically connected to the control circuitry **240**. For example, in this embodiment, the user interface **220** includes a display device **222** having an active area that outputs information to a user and four buttons **224a-d** that receive input from the user. Here, the display **222** may be used to communicate a number of settings or menu options for the system **10**. In this embodiment, the control circuitry **240** may receive the input commands from the user's button selections and thereby cause the display device **222** to output a number of menus or program screens that show particular settings and data (e.g., review data that shows the medicine dispensing rate, the total amount of medicine dispensed in a given time period, the amount of medicine scheduled to be dispensed at a particular time or date, the approximate amount of medicine remaining the cartridge **120**, or the like). As previously described, the controller circuit **240** can be programmable in that the input commands from the button selections can cause the controller circuit **240** to change any one of a number of settings for the infusion pump system **100**.

(69) Some embodiments of the control circuitry **240** may include a cable connector (e.g., a USB connection port or another data cable port) that is accessible on an external portion of the controller housing **210**. As such, a cable may be connected to the control circuitry **240** to upload data or program settings to the controller circuit or to download data from the control circuitry **240**. For example, historical data of medicine delivery can be downloaded from the control circuitry **240** (via the cable connector) to a computer system of a physician or a user for purposes of analysis and program adjustments. Optionally, the data cable may also provide recharging power.

(70) Still referring to FIG. **15**, the control circuitry **240** of the controller device **200** may include a second power source **245** that can receive electrical energy from a first power source **345** (FIG. **17**) housed in the pump device **100**. In this embodiment, the second power source **245** is coupled to the power supply board **244** of the control circuitry **240**. The hard-wired transmission of the electrical energy can occur through the previously described connectors **118** and **218** (FIGS. **4-5**). In such circumstances, the first power source **345** (FIG. **17**) may include a high density battery that is capable of providing a relatively large amount of electrical energy for its package size, while the second power source **245** (FIG. **15**) may include a high current-output battery that is capable discharging a brief current burst to power the drive system **300** of the pump device **100**.

Accordingly, the first battery **345** (FIG. **17**) disposed in the pump device **100** can be used to deliver electrical energy over time (e.g., "trickle charge") to the second battery **245** when the controller device **200** is removably attached to the pump device **100**. For example, as previously described, the first battery **345** (FIG. **17**) may comprise a zinc-air cell battery. The zinc-air cell battery may have a large volumetric energy density compared to some other battery types. For example, the

zinc-air cell battery may have a volumetric energy density of greater than about 900 Watt-hours/Liter (Wh/L), about 1000 Wh/L to about 1700 Wh/L, and about 1200 Wh/L to about 1600 Wh/L. Also, the zinc-air cell battery may have a long storage life, especially in those embodiments in which the battery is sealed (e.g., by the removable tab **141** or the like) during storage and before activation. One exemplary zinc-air cell battery provides a potential voltage of about 1.1V to about 1.6V (about 1.2V to about 1.4 V, and about 1.3 V in one embodiment), a current output of about 8 mA to about 12 mA (about 10 mA in one embodiment), and a storage capacity of greater than about 600 mA.Math.h (about 650 mA.Math.h in one embodiment).

(71) As shown in FIG. **15**, the second battery **245** may include a high current-output device that is housed inside the controller housing **210**. The second battery **245** can be charged over a period of time by the first battery **345** (FIG. **17**) and then intermittently deliver high-current bursts to the drive system **300** over a brief moment of time. For example, the second battery **245** may comprise a lithium-polymer battery. The lithium polymer battery disposed in the controller device **200** may have an initial current output that is greater than the zinc-air cell battery disposed in the pump device **100**, but zinc-air cell battery may have an energy density that is greater than the lithium polymer battery (e.g., the lithium polymer battery disposed in the controller device **200** may have a volumetric energy density of less than about 600 Wh/L). In addition, the lithium-polymer battery **245** is readily rechargeable, which permits the zinc-air battery disposed in the pump device **100** to provide electrical energy to the lithium-polymer battery **245** for purposes of recharging. One exemplary lithium-polymer battery provides a initial current output of about greater than 80 mA (about 90 mA to about 110 mA, and about 100 mA in one embodiment) and a maximum potential voltage of about 4.0V to and 4.4V (about 4.2 V in one embodiment). In other embodiments, it should be understood that the second power source **245** may comprise a capacitor device capable of being recharged over time and intermittently discharging a current burst to activate the drive system **300**.

(72) Accordingly, the infusion pump system **10** having two power sources **245**, **345**, one arranged in the pump device **100** and another arranged in the reusable controller device **200**, permits a user to continually operate the controller device **200** without having to recharge a battery via a wall-plug or other cable. Because the controller device **200** can be reusable with a number of pump devices **100** (e.g., attach the new pump device **100'** after the previous pump device **100** is expended and disposed), the second power source **245** in the controller device **200** can be recharged over a period of time each time a new pump device **100** is connected thereto. Such a configuration can be advantageous in those embodiments in which the pump device **100** is configured to be a disposable, one-time-use device that attaches to a reusable controller device **200**. For example, in those embodiments, the “disposable” pump devices **100** recharge the second power source **245** in the “reusable” controller device **200**, thereby reducing or possibly eliminating the need for separate recharging of the controller device **200** via a power cord plugged into a wall outlet.

(73) Still referring to FIG. **15**, the control circuitry **240** includes an external reference system **230** having a receiver **232** and an external reference circuitry **234**. The receiver **232** communicates with the external reference circuitry **234** and receives a signal indicative of a time, a date, or both from a remote time and date reference source **235** (or **236**). For example, the remote time and date reference source **235** (or **236**) may include a radio transmitter, a satellite, a cellular telephone tower, or other signal broadcasting source. As explained in further detail below, the remote reference source **235** (or **236**) broadcasts a reference signal that may be contemporaneously broadcasted or otherwise transmitted to multiple devices including, but not limited to, the portable medical devices, such as the infusion pump system **10**, described herein. Thus, in these embodiments, the broadcast signal is not necessarily transmitted exclusively to a targeted device, but can be transmitted over a broad geographical area and can be received by more than one device (e.g., the infusion pump system **10**, other medical devices, cell phones, GPS monitor devices, radio devices, and others).

(74) In this embodiment, the receiver **232** is illustrated as extending to a region along the controller housing **210**. In alternative embodiments, the receiver **232** can be fully housed within the controller housing **210**. In response to receiving the broadcast signal indicative of the time/date from the remote time and date reference source **235** (or **236**), the receiver **232** sends a corresponding signal to the external reference circuitry **234**. The external reference circuitry **234** processes the signal and sends a time/date update signal to the processor **243** of the control circuitry **240**, which regulates operation of the infusion pump system **10** based thereon. The processor **243** can include an internal reference circuitry, which is automatically updated based on the time/date update signal. This automatic update may occur at predetermined events. For example, the automatic update may occur upon replacement of a battery, at regularly scheduled intervals (e.g., every 5, 10, 15, 30 minutes, every hour, every few hours, twice daily, once daily, as a few examples). In alternative embodiments, the automatic update may occur continuously.

(75) The external reference system **230** enables the infusion pump system **10** (FIG. **1**) to have an internally stored reference time that is updated by an external time signal. The external time signal may include a broadcast signal generated by a radio clock transmitter, a cellular telephone system and/or a global positioning system (GPS). In this manner, an accurate reference time for the infusion pump system **10**. By updating and maintaining the internal time and date settings, the pump system **10** may provide the basal delivery of medicine at the correct times according to the predetermined delivery schedule. Furthermore, the system may include computer-readable memory in the controller device **200** that can record dispensation data and other data along with accurate time-stamps that are based on the updated time and date information. Accordingly, some medical decisions, which are based on a review of pumping details, can be made with confidence knowing that the time and date information was accurate when it was recorded.

(76) Still referring to FIG. **15**, some embodiments of the external reference system **230** may be provided as a radio clock system, which is synchronized by a time code bit stream that is transmitted by a radio transmitter **236**. The radio transmitter **236** can be coupled to a time standard, such as an atomic clock, so that the radio transmitter broadcasts a time/date signal indicative of the time standard. In the case of a radio clock system, the receiver **232** includes an antenna that receives a radio frequency (RF) time code signal, and the external reference circuitry **234** includes a receiving circuit, which converts the RF time/date code signal into a digital time/date code signal. The external reference circuitry **234** or another component of the control circuitry **240** can decode the digital code signal and outputs a time/date signal. For example, in the case of a radio clock system, the remote time and date reference source can include one or more of the following: U.S. NIST (National Institute of Standards and Technology) broadcasts U.S. Longwave radio station WWVB at 60 kHz and 50 kW U.S. Shortwave radio station WWV at 2.5, 5, 10, 15 and 20 MHz and 2.5-10 kW U.S. Shortwave radio station WWVH at 2.5, 5, 10 and 15 MHz and 2.5-10 kW German broadcasts from DCF77 (Mainflingen) at 77.5 kHz Canadian broadcasts from CHU (Ottawa) at 3.33, 7.335 and 14.67 MHz UK broadcasts from MSF (an atomic clock near Rugby) at 60 kHz Japanese broadcasts from JJY radio stations at 40/60 kHz Chinese broadcasts from the BPM radio station (Xi'an) at 2.5, 5, 10 and 15 MHz Swiss Broadcasts from the HBG longwave transmitter (Prangins) at 75 kHz French broadcasts from radio station TDF (Allouis) at 162 kHz

(77) In another embodiment, the external reference system **230** may be configured to receive a GPS clock signal that is transmitted from a GPS satellite **235** or other satellite. The GPS clock system combines time estimates from multiple satellite atomic clocks with error estimates maintained by a network or ground stations. Because GPS clocks simultaneously compute the time and position from several sources, they can automatically compensate for line-of-sight delay and many radio propagation defects. Furthermore, GPS clocks may achieve sub-microsecond precision under ideal conditions. The GPS clock provides sufficient accuracy in that the displayed time will be accurate to approximately one half of a second, which can be adequate for medical device purposes. The GPS clock system may operate with one or more of a GPS satellite, a Galileo satellite and a

GLONASS (Global Navigation Satellite System). These satellite navigation systems have a caesium or rubidium atomic clock on each satellite, reference to a clock or clocks on the Earth. Some navigation units can serve as local time standards, with a precision of about one microsecond (μs).

(78) In still another embodiment, the external reference source **235** may include a cellular telephone time signal (e.g., from one or more cellular towers, from a cellular base station, or from a cellular satellite). In an exemplary embodiment, a CDMA (code division multiple access) clock may be implemented, which include high quality standard time signals.

(79) In other embodiments, the external reference source **235** can include a computer, such as a desktop computer or a laptop computer. The pump device **100** can be coupled to the computer to electronically communicate with the computer. This can be achieved using a wired connection or a wireless connection, such as a Bluetooth connection, between the pump device **100** and the computer. The external time reference can be provided using the network time protocol (NTP) of a network, of which the computer is a part. NTP functions to synchronize the clocks of computers over a network. By coupling the pump device **100** to the computer, the pump device **100** can function as an extension of the network and the time reference of the pump device **100** can be synchronized like that of other components of the network. It is also anticipated that the pump device **100** can directly communicate with an NTP server or a National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) server, either of which can provide the external time reference.

(80) The external reference system **230** may provide a number of advantages when implemented in a medical device, such as the previously described pump system **10**. For example, the external reference system **230** can be used to maintain accurate time and date information even in the event of a power interruption. In particular, when the power is removed during a battery change and/or the battery depletes over time, the internal reference time can be affected. After the power is replaced, the external reference system **230** can communicate with the remote time and date reference source **235**, **236** to accurately update the internal reference time and date. In this manner, the external reference system **230** can reduce the risk of the reference time either not being updated or not being accurately updated by the user. Furthermore, the accuracy of the internal reference time can be maintained throughout the operation of the medical device.

(81) Some of these advantages are particularly highlighted in the case where the medical device includes an insulin pump system, such as the portable infusion pump system **10** described in connection with FIGS. 1-3. More specifically, the insulin pump system **10** can provide time-based dosing of basal insulin. As such, the basal dosing rate may be adjusted by the controller device **200** based on the particular time of day. For example, the dosing rate can be set at one level early in the morning, when the user is first awakening. The controller device **200** may automatically adjust the dosing rate to a different level at mealtimes or in the evening, for example. Accordingly, the external reference system **230** provides an accurate time setting to ensure that the dosing rate is appropriate for the time of day.

(82) In some cases, a user may suspend or otherwise take a break from treatment, which may lead the user to remove the power supply from the medical device (e.g., to render alarms inactive). In such circumstances, the internal reference time may become inaccurate when the medical device is reactivated. The external reference system **230** can resolve this inaccuracy by enabling the internal reference time to be automatically updated based on the external reference signal from the remote time and date reference source **235**, **236**. Thus, the use of the medical device can be simplified, because the user is not required to manually set the time and date. Furthermore, the documentation, such as an instruction manual, which accompanies the medical device, may be simplified. For example, instructions on how to manually set the time and date may not be required.

(83) Referring to FIG. 16, the external reference system **230** can also be implemented to automatically adjust the dosing schedule in the case of a time change. In one example, at certain times of the year, the local time of a particular location may increase or decrease to account for

daylight savings time. In other instances, a user may travel between time zones, where the time change can be several hours or even an entire day. The external reference system **230** can alert the user to such time changes and assist the user in adapting the dosing schedule to the new time zone. In some instances, the time zone change may be for a brief time period, such as when a user travels out of his/her home time zone for a brief period and then returns. In such a case, the user may instruct the insulin pump system **10** to function as normal, without adjusting the dosing rate to the new time zone.

(84) In the case where the dosing rate is to be adjusted to a time change, an adaptive time-shift learning feature can be provided. In one embodiment, the user can indicate to the insulin pump system **10** (e.g., via a button on the controller device **200**), as to when the first dosing should occur. For example, when the user awakens in the morning after a time change has occurred, the user can press a button or other input to instruct the initial dosing to occur at that time. In this manner, the dosing schedule can automatically adjust based on the timing of the initial dosing. In addition or in the alternative, the user can indicate to the insulin pump system **10**, as to when a mealtime (e.g., the first mealtime) is to occur after a time change. For example, when the user prepares for a meal after arriving in a new time zone or after a time change has occurred, the user may press a button or other input to alert the insulin pump system **10**. In this manner, the dosing schedule may automatically adjust based on the timing of a meal.

(85) In another embodiment, the dosing rate may be gradually adjusted based on the time change. More specifically, the dosing schedule, which is controlled by the controller device **200**, may be incrementally shifted to adjust to the time change. For example, the dosing schedule may be shifted X minutes per hour until the dosing schedule corresponds with the new time. The value X can increase or decrease based on the time change. For example, the value X may be lower for a small time change than that for a larger time change. In one embodiment, the value X may be limited to avoid an overly aggressive shift.

(86) Furthermore, the value X can be a function of the rate at which the user's internal time reference changes. More specifically, the hypothalamus gland of the user regulates certain metabolic processes and other autonomic activities. The hypothalamus also coordinates seasonal and circadian rhythms. A circadian rhythm is a roughly 24-hour cycle in the physiological processes of living beings. The value X can relate to the circadian rhythm of the user.

(87) As an alternative embodiment, the dosing schedule, which is controlled by the controller device **200**, may adjust to conform to the new time zone by making a step-shift. For example, if the user travels to a time zone that is one hour ahead/behind of the user's home time zone, the dosing schedule may step-shift one hour forward/backward, upon request of the user. The amount of the step-shift may be limited to avoid occurrences of too much or too little dosing. For example, if the step-shift would result in over- or under-dosing, the user is alerted and the step-shift in the dosing schedule does not occur. In some embodiments, the user can anticipate a time change and can initiate a dosing schedule adaptation prior to the time change. For example, the user may be preparing for a trip to a different time zone and can initiate a change in the dosing schedule prior to departing on the trip. In this manner, the effect of a time zone change can be better managed and minimized.

(88) Referring to FIG. **16**, a flowchart illustrates an exemplary adaptive time-shift learning process **1600**. At step **1602**, the controller device **200** updates the date and/or time based on the external reference signal transmitted from the external reference source **235**, **236** to the receiver **232**. At step **1604**, the controller device **200** determines whether there is a significant time change. For example, a significant time change occurs when the time is shifted by at least a threshold amount (e.g., greater than about 15 minutes, greater than about 30 minutes, and about 1 hour). Exemplary significant time changes include, but are not limited to, a time change due to daylight savings time and/or a time change due to a transition between time zones. If there is no significant time change, the external reference system **230** can automatically adjust the internal reference time of the

controller device **200** without any further user input, and the process **1600** can loop back to step **1602**. If there is a significant time change, the exemplary adaptive time-shift learning determines the amount of the time change at step **1606**.

(89) At step **1608**, the controller device **200** alerts the patient as to the time change. At step **1610**, it is determined whether the dosing schedule is to be adjusted. This determination can be based on the patient's input. For example, the user may decide that no adjustment is necessary (e.g., in the case where the user has only briefly transitioned between time zones). If there is no adjustment to be made, the adaptive time-shift process ends. If an adjustment is to be made, the controller device **200** determines whether a push-button adjustment is to be made at step **1612**. If no push-button adjustment is to be made, the exemplary adaptive time-shift process continues at step **1614**. If a push-button adjustment is to be made, the controller device **200** adjusts the dosing schedule based on a user input at step **1616**. More specifically, the dosing schedule may be adjusted based on the user indicating an initial dosing for the day and/or the user indicating a mealtime (e.g., breakfast, lunch and/or dinner), as described in further detail above.

(90) At step **1614**, the controller device **200** determines whether a gradual adjustment is to be made. If a gradual adjustment is to be made, the controller device **200** adjusts the dosing schedule based on the above-described rate (i.e., X value) at step **1618**. If a gradual dosing schedule adjustment is not to be made, the controller device **200** conforms the dosing schedule to the new time at step **1620**. For example, the dosing schedule may step-shift forward or backward based on the new time. Such a step-shift may be limited, however, based on several factors including, but not limited to, the current dosing rate, the dosing rate after the step-shift, a recent dosing history and the like. In this manner, it may be insured that the user does not receive too much or too little insulin, for example, as a result of the step-shift.

(91) Referring now to FIG. **17**, as previously described, the infusion pump system includes the pump device **100** having a drive system **300** controlled by the removable controller device **200** (FIGS. **1-2**). Accordingly, the drive system **300** can accurately and incrementally dispense fluid from the pump device **100** in a controlled manner. The drive system **300** may include a flexible piston rod **370** that is incrementally advanced toward the medicine cartridge **120** so as to dispense the medicine from the pump device **100**. At least a portion of the drive system **300** is mounted, in this embodiment, to the pump housing **110**. In this embodiment, the pump housing **110** includes a chassis **107**, a shell portion **108**, and a cover mount **109**. The shell portion **108** can be used to cover at least a portion of the drive system **300**. For example, the shell **108** may include an inner curved surface against which a curved section of a piston rod **370** rests. The cover mount **109** may be assembled to the chassis **107** of the pump housing **110** to secure some components of the drive system **300** in position between the cover mount **109** and the chassis **107**. When the cover mount **109** is assembled into place, the “unused” or retracted portion of the piston rod **370** may rest in a channel defined in the top of the cover mount **109**. The shell portion **108** can slide over the cover mount **109** and join with the chassis **107** to form the assembled pump housing **110**.

(92) Some embodiments of the drive system **300** may include a battery powered actuator (e.g., reversible motor **320** or the like) that drives a gear system **330** to actuate a ratchet-spring mechanism and advance the flexible piston rod **370** toward the medicine cartridge **120** (as described in commonly assigned U.S. patent application Ser. No. 11/677,706 filed on Feb. 22, 2007, which is incorporated herein by reference). Accordingly, control signals from the controller device **200** can be transmitted via the electrical connector **118** so as to control the motor **320**, which causes the gear system **330** and other components to actuate and thereby advance the piston rod **370** an incremental distance toward the medicine cartridge. This incremental motion urges the plunger **125** (FIG. **1**) of the medicine cartridge **120** to force an incremental amount of medicine from the pump device **100**. Accordingly, in response to the electrical control signals from the controller device **200**, the drive system **300** of the pump device **100** causes medicine to incrementally dispense from the medicine cartridge **120** and into the targeted user.

(93) It should be understood from the description herein that, in some embodiments, the external reference system can be arranged in medical devices other than the wearable infusion pump system **10**. For example, medical devices for the treatment of diabetes that are carried or otherwise worn by the user can incorporate an external reference system configured to receive an external signal from a remote time and date reference source (e.g., a radio transmitter, a satellite, another broadcast source or the like). As such, these diabetes treatment devices (e.g., infusion pumps, glucose meters, continuous glucose monitors, and the like) can be equipped to include automatic time-setting capabilities and related maintenance features.

(94) Referring to FIG. **18**, some embodiments of a continuous glucose monitoring system **600** can incorporate an external reference system **630** that includes a receiver **632** and external reference circuitry **634**. These instruments **632** and **634** can be used to receive and decode the external reference signal that is broadcast from a remote time and date reference source **635** (e.g., a satellite, a radio transmitter, a cellular system, or another broadcast source). Similar to the previously described infusion pump system **10**, the continuous glucose monitoring system **600** is configured to receive an external signal from the remote time and date reference source **635** to provide automatic time-setting capabilities and related maintenance features.

(95) As shown in FIG. **18**, the continuous glucose monitoring system **600** includes a body-worn glucose sensor device **610** that wirelessly communicates with a portable controller device **620**. The glucose sensor device **610** may comprise a sensor shaft **619** that penetrates under the skin (e.g., into the subcutaneous layer) while the sensor housing is adhered to the skin. The sensor housing may contain a power source and a communication device **615** that permits the sensor data to be wirelessly transmitted to the controller device **620**. The controller device **620** can include a display **622** to communicate the sensed glucose level and one or more buttons **624** for user interaction. The controller device **620** can include one or more memory devices that store a log of the sensed glucose readings and the time and date that each reading was detected. As such, the user or a medical practitioner can perform a retrospective analysis of the user's blood glucose readings to determine if modifications should be made to the user's food consumption, physical activity, and insulin dosages.

(96) In this embodiment, the controller device **200** includes the external reference system **630** that includes the receiver **632** and the external reference circuitry **634**. The receiver **632** receives a signal indicative of a time, a date, or both from the remote time and date reference source **635**. In response to receiving the broadcast signal indicative of the time/date from the remote time and date reference source **635**, the receiver **632** sends a corresponding signal to the external reference circuitry **634**. The external reference circuitry **634** processes the signal and sends a time/date update signal to the control circuitry of the device **620**. The controller device **620** can include an internal reference circuitry, which is automatically updated based on the new time/date data from the external reference circuitry **634**. This automatic update may occur at predetermined events. For example, the automatic update may occur upon replacement of a battery, at regularly scheduled intervals (e.g., every 5, 10, 15, 30 minutes, every hour, every few hours, twice daily, once daily, as a few examples). In alternative embodiments, the automatic update may occur continuously.

(97) Still referring to FIG. **18**, the external reference system **630** enables the continuous glucose monitoring system **600** to have an internally stored reference time that is updated by an external time signal. The external time signal may include a broadcast signal generated by a radio clock transmitter, a cellular telephone system and/or a global positioning system (GPS). In this manner, an accurate reference time for the continuous glucose monitoring system **600** can be maintained. This accurate reference time, for example, enables the continuous glucose monitoring system **600** to include an accurate time-stamp for each of the glucose readings that are stored in the previously described log. Because the sensor data that is collected and stored within the memory of the controller device **620** can include an associated time-stamp, the subsequent analysis of the recorded data is enhanced due to the high accuracy of the time-stamp. Accordingly, some medical decisions,

which are based on a review of pumping details, can be made with confidence knowing that the time and date information was accurate when it was recorded.

(98) It should be understood from the description herein that, in some embodiments, the external reference system can be arranged other medical devices for the treatment of diabetes. For example, a blood glucose meter device can incorporate an external reference system configured to receive an external signal from a remote time and date reference source (e.g., a radio transmitter, a satellite, another broadcast source or the like). Such a glucose meter device can be carried by a diabetic user so that the user may periodically provide a blood sample on a test strip and then insert the test blood strip into the meter device for a periodic glucose reading.

(99) In some embodiments, the glucose meter device can include a mechanism for piercing a user's skin to allow a limited amount of blood to pass to the surface of the skin (e.g., a blood drop for the test strip). The user can apply the blood as a blood sample to a test blood strip. An end of the test blood strip, which includes the applied blood sample, can be inserted into a strip receiver of the glucose meter device. As such, the glucose meter device can test the blood sample to determine the user's current blood glucose level. The determined blood glucose level can be provided to the user visually (e.g., using a display) and/or audibly (e.g., using a speaker). Furthermore, the glucose meter device can be configured to store the glucose readings in a log (e.g., stored in one or more memory devices of the glucose meter control circuitry). These stored reading may be associated with a time stamp that indicates the time and date of the blood glucose reading. The glucose meter device can be equipped with the external reference system (as previously described) to receive a reference time and date signal and thereafter update the internal time and date settings in the control circuitry. Such an automated time updating feature can ensure that the log's time-stamp for each glucose reading is accurate, which can be beneficial to a physician or user who is performing a retrospective analysis of the user's blood glucose level throughout portions of the day or week.

(100) Thus, a number of diabetes treatment devices (e.g., infusion pumps, glucose meters, continuous glucose monitors, and the like) can be equipped to include automatic time-setting capabilities and related maintenance features described herein.

(101) A number of embodiments of the invention have been described. Nevertheless, it will be understood that various modifications may be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention. Accordingly, other embodiments are within the scope of the following claims.

Claims

1. A method of operating an infusion pump system for treatment of diabetes, comprising: slidably attaching a cartridge comprising a fluid medicine to a pump device and removably coupling an exterior portion of the pump device with an exterior portion of a portable controller device, the portable controller device having a user interface display device and, when coupled with the pump device, is in electrical communication with the pump device, the pump device including a drive system configured to deliver the fluid medicine from the cartridge; applying a cap device to the cartridge to initiate movement of a plunger and prime the cartridge; automatically receiving without requesting, at the portable controller device, a signal indicative of a time of day; comparing time stored in the portable controller device to time of day provided by the signal indicative of time of day; based on a result of the comparison indicating a difference below a threshold amount between the time stored in the portable controller device and the time of day provided by the signal indicative of time of day, automatically updating an internal time setting of the portable controller device according to the signal indicative of the time of day; adjusting a dosing rate of the fluid medicine based on the updated internal time setting; and operating the portable controller device to actuate the drive system of the pump device based on the adjusted dosing rate of the fluid medicine.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the step of updating the internal time setting of the portable controller device includes receiving by internal control circuitry of the portable controller device a

time-and-date update signal from an external reference source.

3. The method of claim 2, wherein the external reference source is a computer configured to communicate via short range wireless communications with the portable controller device.

4. The method of claim 2, wherein the external reference source is connected to a computer network having a network time protocol.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein the step of automatically receiving the signal indicative of the time of day occurs repeatedly at predetermined intervals of time.

6. The method of claim 1, further comprising: storing data in a computer-readable memory of the portable controller device; and time-stamping data received from a glucose sensor device based on the updated internal time setting.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein the user interface display device of the portable controller device shows a time value indicative of the updated internal time setting.

8. The method of claim 1, wherein: the pump device further includes: a pump housing to contain the drive system and to define a space for the cartridge, and a first electrical connector that is externally accessible along the pump housing; and the portable controller device further includes: a controller housing to mechanically mate with the pump housing, control circuitry housed within the controller housing, a second electrical connector that is externally accessible along the controller housing and that is engageable with the first electrical connector to provide electrical communication between the control circuitry of the portable controller device and the drive system of the pump device, the user interface display device being electrically connected to the control circuitry, and a wireless communication antenna system is electrically connected to the control circuitry.

9. The method of claim 1, wherein the portable controller device activates the drive system of the pump device according to a dispensing rate schedule based on the time of day.

10. The method of claim 9, further comprising identifying a time-zone change based on the signal indicative of the time of day and shifting the dispensing rate schedule based on the time-zone change.

11. The method of claim 10, wherein the dispensing rate schedule is incrementally shifted to gradually correspond to the time-zone change.

12. The method of claim 10, wherein the dispensing rate schedule is step shifted to immediately correspond to the time-zone change.

13. The method of claim 10, further comprising: querying a user via the user interface display device to confirm whether operation of the infusion pump system should be adjusted based on the time-zone change, and wherein the dispensing rate schedule shifting based on the time-zone change is only executed in response to an input to the user interface display device.

14. The method of claim 1, wherein the pump device comprises: a pump housing that defines a space to slidably receive the cartridge, wherein the pump device includes at least one retainer structure within the space to slideably receive the cartridge, the at least one retainer structure configured to hinder removal of the cartridge after being received in the space and thereby prevent reuse of the pump device with a new cartridge.

15. The method of claim 1, wherein the pump device comprises: a pump housing including an interior cavity to define a space to slidably receive the cartridge inserted through an external opening of the pump housing, wherein the cap device is configured to mate with the pump housing and cover the external opening so as to seal the cartridge in the interior cavity.

16. The method of claim 1, wherein the signal indicative of the time of day is automatically provided using a network time protocol (NTP) of a computer network.

17. The method of claim 1, wherein the signal indicative of the time of day is automatically received by a wireless communication antenna system from a remote signal broadcasting source.

18. The method of claim 1, further comprising: configuring the pump device with a skin adhesive patch, wherein the skin adhesive patch is operable to adhere to the skin of a user.

19. The method of claim 1, wherein the cap device is configured to cause the plunger to engage a piston rod.
